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Iran disputes claim of talks

Trump extends deadline for Tehran to reopen Hormuz

By Jon Gambrell, Elena Becatoros and Samy Magdy
ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI, United Arab Emirates — President Donald Trump said Monday the U.S. was talking with a “respected” Iranian leader and claimed the Islamic Republic was eager for a deal to end the war. He also extended a deadline for Iran to reopen the Strait of Hormuz or face attacks on its power plants, saying it has an additional five days.

Trump’s turnaround, which held out the possibility of resolving the war now in its fourth week, served to drive down oil prices and jolt stocks upward. It offered a reprieve after the U.S. and Iran traded threats over the weekend that could have cut electricity to millions in Iran and around the Gulf, and knocked out desalination plants providing many desert nations with drinking water.

Trump told reporters Iran wants “to make a deal,” and he claimed U.S. envoy Steve Witkoff and Trump’s son-in-law Jared Kushner had held talks Sunday with an Iranian leader. He did not say who that was, but said the U.S. has not talked to Supreme Leader Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei.

Iran denied talks had been held. “No negotiations have been held with the US,” Iranian parliament Speaker Mohammad Bagher Qalibaf posted on X, adding that “fake-news is used to manipulate the financial and oil markets.”

Trump said if a deal is reached, the U.S. would move to take Iran’s enriched uranium, which is critical to its disputed nuclear program. Iran has adamantly refused such demands in the past, insisting it has the right to enrich uranium for peaceful purposes.

Iran has already performed 99% of the centrifuge work required to produce weapons-grade uranium for nine nuclear weapons, said

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A passenger looks at two masked Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents who stand just inside a passenger exit area in Terminal 1 at Chicago O'Hare International Airport on Monday. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

ICE deployed to O’Hare as TSA goes without pay

Amid partial government shutdown, at least a dozen agents stand near exits

By Talia Soglin and Jake Sheridan
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The federal government has deployed scores of U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement officers to O’Hare International Airport in the midst of an ongoing partial government shutdown, and agents were seen Monday milling around the airport terminals.

At least a dozen agents stood

at exits throughout the airport, appearing to do very little. Several scrolled on their phones. Others stood and chatted with one another or Transportation Security Administration agents, who are working unpaid.

Despite President Donald Trump on Monday directing ICE officers not to wear face coverings in their work at airports, most at O’Hare wore medical face masks. All wore bulletproof tactical vests. Some were armed.

Brad Hackney looked confused when he passed them after a flight from Lexington, Kentucky.

“They don’t belong here,” he said. “They don’t belong stalking people coming off of planes, going into the airports. There’s no reason for any American to feel threatened traveling throughout the United States. And that’s what they did. It’s just a piece of intimidation.”

Hackney, 47, said the agency has targeted Latinos and argued that

airports should be “like a store,” an off-limits spots for the agents.

“It’s pointless,” he said. “It’s just to cause fear and threat to people.”

But Luis Lannaro was unbothered as he came out the same exit from Minneapolis.

“Honestly, I don’t care, as long as they help and keep the line short,” the Brazilian tourist said before a five-hour stop in Chicago.

In a statement, Chicago Mayor

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Flowers stand on the pier at Tobey Prinz Beach in Chicago’s Rogers Park as people fish on Saturday. Loyola University freshman Sheridan Gorman was fatally shot there Thursday. **CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Tragedy of Loyola student’s killing marked by suspect’s clouded history

Alleged shooter, a Venezuelan migrant, is hospitalized with tuberculosis

By Madeline Buckley, Jeremy Gornor and Sam Charles
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Sheridan Gorman spent the early morning hours on Thursday with friends, watching the skyline on the Loyola Beach Pier, prosecutors said, when she noticed some-

one hiding.

As the group started to run away, Jose Medina, 25, fired a gun, prosecutors alleged Monday, hitting the 18-year-old Loyola University Chicago student in the back while her friends took cover in a grassy area of the beach.

Though a full detention hearing

was postponed because Medina is hospitalized with tuberculosis, Cook County prosecutors gave a brief account of the shooting that plunged the Rogers Park university into mourning and generated international headlines when

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Records: AIPAC funded secretive super PACs

Groups reportedly hid contributors, spent big in Democratic primary

By Jake Sheridan and Olivia Olander
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Newly released records reveal the American Israel Public Affairs Committee, or AIPAC, was the primary funding organization behind two ostensibly independent super PACs that spent heavily to reshape Chicago-area Democratic congressional primaries — a connection the groups did not disclose during the campaign.

The records also show the groups received significant sums from individual megadonors, including Michael Sacks, who led the local host committee for the 2024 Democratic National Convention.

United Democracy Project, AIPAC’s affiliated super PAC, directed more than \$5.3 million to bankroll the groups Elect Chicago

Women and Affordable Chicago Now, according to Federal Election Commission filings released Friday night.

The two super PACs, along with UDP itself, emerged as the largest outside spenders in Chicago’s four competitive congressional primaries, part of a surge that reached an unprecedented \$32.9 million in outside spending. But who was behind and funded the groups remained shrouded until after the March 17 primary election, a tactic that sparked controversy as opponents decried hidden influence.

The newly released records undercut that opacity, showing the groups were largely financed through AIPAC’s network. In addition to the United Democracy Project’s contributions, several major individual donors also funneled money to the two super PACs, each of which has given to AIPAC or United Democracy Project in recent years, according to campaign finance records.

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Man charged in firefighter death detained

Sheaves Slate, 27, of Avondale, accused of starting a fire that led to a Chicago firefighter’s death, was ordered detained during a hearing Monday. He faces first-degree murder, aggravated arson and residential arson charges after allegedly setting a mattress on fire in an apartment building. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

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